

AURELIA AEROSPACE

Corporate, Program, and Industry Overview

Prepared for internal briefing purposes

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This report consolidates publicly available information and internal notes on Aurelia Aerospace and its principal partners, competitors, and regulators, for use in briefing materials. Figures and program timelines should be independently verified before external use.

SECTION 1

Company Overview

Aurelia Aerospace is a commercial launch and satellite manufacturing company headquartered in Huntsville, Alabama. Founded in 2016, the company began as a small-launch contractor before expanding into satellite bus manufacturing and, more recently, in-space servicing. Aurelia operates a primary vehicle assembly facility in Huntsville and a separate satellite integration campus in Broomfield, Colorado.

The company is privately held, with its largest outside shareholder being Halberd Growth Partners, a venture and growth-equity firm based in Menlo Park, California. Aurelia has raised five priced funding rounds since its founding, the most recent of which closed in March 2025 and valued the company at approximately 4.1 billion dollars.

Aurelia's stated strategy is to compete in the mid-size launch segment, roughly between the small-satellite dedicated launchers and the heavy-lift vehicles flown by larger incumbents, while also building a recurring revenue base through its satellite bus product line and a newer orbital servicing division, Aurelia Orbital Services.

SECTION 1A

Founding History and Key Milestones

Aurelia Aerospace traces its origins to a small propulsion consulting practice that Nadia Kowalski ran out of Huntsville, Alabama beginning in 2015, before formally incorporating the company in early 2016 alongside two co-founders, structural engineer Owen Bassett and software lead Renata Cole. Bassett left the company in 2019 to start an unrelated composites firm, and Cole remains with Aurelia today as Vice President of Flight Software.

The company's first several years were spent developing a small-satellite launch vehicle that was ultimately shelved in 2018 in favor of the larger Halcyon program, a strategic pivot Kowalski has described publicly as the closest the company came to running out of capital before its Series A round closed later that year.

Aurelia's first successful orbital launch came in September 2022, when the Halcyon II carried a technology-demonstration payload for Vantage Materials into low Earth orbit from Cape Canaveral. The 2022 acquisition of Driftline Robotics followed roughly two months later, marking the company's first move outside of launch vehicles.

In 2023, Aurelia opened its Broomfield, Colorado satellite integration campus, hiring much of its early satellite engineering staff from Front Range aerospace contractors in the Denver metropolitan area, including Tobias Renner, who joined that year to lead the new facility.

Milestone Timeline

Year	Milestone
2015	Nadia Kowalski begins propulsion consulting practice in Huntsville, Alabama

Year	Milestone
2016	Aurelia Aerospace incorporated with co-founders Owen Bassett and Renata Cole
2018	Small-satellite launch vehicle shelved; Halcyon program begins; Series A closes
2019	Series B round led by Halbard Growth Partners; Marcus Oyelaran joins as CTO
2021	Ferro Composites supply agreement signed
2022	Maiden flight of Halcyon II; acquisition of Driftline Robotics
2023	Broomfield, Colorado campus opens; Aurelia Orbital Services formed
2024	Minority stake in Solenne Avionics; brief FAA grounding after static-fire anomaly
2025	Series E round; Cascade Communications servicing contract signed

SECTION 2

Leadership and Governance

Aurelia's Chief Executive Officer is Nadia Kowalski, who co-founded the company in 2016 after leaving a propulsion engineering role at a larger aerospace prime contractor. Kowalski also holds a board seat and is the company's largest individual shareholder.

The company's Chief Technology Officer, Marcus Oyelaran, joined Aurelia in 2019 from Thornbury Propulsion Labs, a propulsion research firm based in Pasadena, California, where he led development of a staged-combustion engine later licensed to two other launch companies. Oyelaran is credited as the principal architect of Aurelia's Kestrel engine family, which powers the company's flagship launch vehicle.

Aurelia's Chief Financial Officer, Elise Marchetti, joined in 2022 after eleven years in aerospace equity research at a large investment bank in New York City. Marchetti has led the company's last two funding rounds and is widely credited internally with shifting Aurelia's fundraising narrative away from launch cadence and toward recurring satellite-services revenue.

The company's board includes Kowalski, Halberd Growth Partners partner Desmond Yates, and independent director Admiral (Ret.) Constance Ubah, a former U.S. Space Force officer who now advises several aerospace startups on government contracting. Ubah also sits on the board of Meridian Orbital Insurance, an underwriter that covers two of Aurelia's launch contracts.

SECTION 3

Corporate Structure and Subsidiaries

Aurelia Aerospace operates through several subsidiaries and divisions. Aurelia Orbital Services, formed in 2023, handles in-space satellite servicing and was built around technology acquired when Aurelia purchased Driftline Robotics, a small robotics firm based in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, in late 2022. Driftline's founder, Priya Chandrasekaran, now leads Aurelia Orbital Services as its general manager.

In 2024, Aurelia acquired a minority stake in Solenne Avionics, an avionics and flight computer manufacturer located in Toulouse, France, giving Aurelia preferred access to Solenne's

radiation-hardened flight computers for its satellite bus line. Solenne Avionics continues to operate independently and also supplies avionics to two of Aurelia's launch competitors.

Aurelia's satellite integration campus in Broomfield, Colorado is operated under a wholly owned subsidiary, Aurelia Satellite Systems, led by Vice President Tobias Renner, who previously worked at a satellite manufacturer in El Segundo, California before joining Aurelia in 2020.

Subsidiary Snapshot

Entity	Relationship to Aurelia	Location	Leadership
Aurelia Orbital Services	Wholly owned division	Huntsville, Alabama	Priya Chandrasekaran
Aurelia Satellite Systems	Wholly owned subsidiary	Broomfield, Colorado	Tobias Renner
Solenne Avionics	Minority stake (2024)	Toulouse, France	Independent management
Driftline Robotics	Acquired 2022; folded into Orbital Services	Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania	Absorbed

SECTION 4

Vehicle and Product Line

Aurelia's flagship launch vehicle is the Halcyon II, a two-stage medium-lift rocket capable of delivering roughly six metric tons to low Earth orbit. The Halcyon II is powered by five Kestrel-7 engines on its first stage, the propulsion family originally developed by Marcus Oyelaran at Thornbury Propulsion Labs and refined after his move to Aurelia.

The company's earlier vehicle, the Halcyon I, was retired from active service in 2023 after eleven flights, and its final flight carried a technology-demonstration payload for Vantage Materials, a materials-science company based in Cambridge, Massachusetts.

On the satellite side, Aurelia manufactures the Corvus bus, a modular small-satellite platform sold to commercial and government customers who supply their own payloads. The Corvus bus was originally designed under Tobias Renner's team at the Broomfield campus and has since been adopted by three announced customers, including a constellation operator based in Singapore.

Aurelia Orbital Services markets a servicing spacecraft called Tether, intended to extend the operational life of geostationary satellites through refueling and orbit adjustment. Tether's core robotic arm technology originates from Driftline Robotics' pre-acquisition research program.

Product Line Summary

Product	Category	Developed By	Status
Halcyon I	Launch vehicle	Aurelia Aerospace	Retired 2023
Halcyon II	Launch vehicle	Aurelia Aerospace	Active

Product	Category	Developed By	Status
Kestrel-7 engine	Propulsion	Marcus Oyelaran / Aurelia	Active
Corvus bus	Satellite platform	Aurelia Satellite Systems	Active
Tether	Servicing spacecraft	Aurelia Orbital Services / Driftline Robotics	In development

SECTION 5

Manufacturing and Supply Chain

Aurelia assembles the Halcyon II airframe at its Huntsville facility, but sources several major subsystems externally. Structural composite sections are supplied by Ferro Composites, a manufacturer based in Mobile, Alabama, under a long-term supply agreement signed in 2021.

Flight avionics for the Halcyon II are supplied primarily by Solenne Avionics, the Toulouse-based firm in which Aurelia holds a minority stake, though Aurelia has maintained a secondary avionics supplier, Redline Systems of Ann Arbor, Michigan, to reduce single-source risk following a 2022 avionics delivery delay.

Turbopump components are manufactured by Castellan Precision Machining, located in Waco, Texas, which also supplies turbopump hardware to a competing launch company. Aurelia's propellant supplier, liquid oxygen and kerosene provider Basin Fuels, operates a production facility near the Huntsville site under a multi-year supply contract.

Aurelia's satellite bus program draws additional components from a shorter, less concentrated supply base than the launch vehicle side. Solar array panels for the Corvus bus are supplied by Meridian PhotoVoltaics, a solar-cell manufacturer based in Golden, Colorado, chosen in part for its proximity to the Broomfield integration campus, while reaction wheels and star trackers are sourced from Halden Precision Instruments of Rochester, New York.

Following the 2022 avionics delay attributed to Solenne Avionics, Aurelia's supply chain team, led by procurement director Ana Beaumont, implemented a dual-source qualification requirement for any single component representing more than eight percent of a vehicle's bill of materials, a policy that led directly to the Redline Systems secondary avionics arrangement.

SECTION 6

Facilities and Launch Sites

Aurelia does not operate its own launch pad. Halcyon II missions fly from Space Launch Complex 46 at Cape Canaveral Space Force Station in Florida, under a commercial use agreement with the United States Space Force. Aurelia also holds an option, not yet exercised, on a second pad at the Wallops Flight Facility in Virginia, which it would use for a planned higher-cadence variant of the vehicle.

The company's Huntsville facility handles final vehicle assembly and static-fire testing, while engine-level testing for the Kestrel-7 is conducted at a leased test stand at the NASA Marshall Space Flight Center,

also located in Huntsville, under an agreement that gives Aurelia scheduled access to government test infrastructure.

Aurelia's satellite integration and clean-room facilities are located at the Broomfield, Colorado campus, roughly twenty miles from Aurelia Satellite Systems' primary customer base of Front Range aerospace contractors.

SECTION 6A

International Operations

While Aurelia's manufacturing and launch operations remain concentrated in the United States, the company's supply chain and customer base are increasingly international. Its avionics relationship with Solenne Avionics in Toulouse, France represents Aurelia's largest single overseas commitment, and the company has stationed a small liaison engineering team at Solenne's facility since 2024 to coordinate flight-computer qualification testing.

Aurelia's satellite bus customer Solstice Constellations, based in Singapore, represents the company's first Asian commercial customer, and Aurelia has said it is evaluating a regional support office in Singapore should the relationship expand beyond the initial Corvus bus order.

The company's investor base also extends internationally through Solaris Sovereign Fund, based in Abu Dhabi, which joined Aurelia's capitalization table as part of the 2025 Series E round. Aurelia has stated that Solaris holds no board seat and no special governance rights beyond standard investor protections.

Aurelia does not currently hold any launch licenses outside the United States, and Kowalski has said publicly that international launch operations are not part of the company's roadmap through at least 2028.

SECTION 6B

Workforce and Organizational Culture

Aurelia employed approximately 1,450 people as of early 2026, the majority based at the Huntsville, Alabama headquarters and vehicle assembly facility, with a smaller workforce of roughly 300 at the Broomfield, Colorado satellite campus and fewer than 50 at Aurelia Orbital Services' Pittsburgh-origin engineering team, which relocated to Huntsville following the Driftline acquisition.

The company has faced some public scrutiny over its workplace culture. A 2024 investigative article in a regional Alabama business publication described a demanding on-call testing schedule at the Huntsville facility during periods leading up to static-fire tests, though the article did not allege any safety violations and Aurelia disputed characterizations of the schedule as unsustainable.

Aurelia's engineering leadership has historically been drawn heavily from two sources: alumni of larger legacy aerospace primes, and, following the Driftline acquisition, robotics engineers with backgrounds in industrial automation rather than traditional spaceflight, a mix that Chief Technology Officer Marcus Oyelaran has described as central to the company's approach to the Tether servicing spacecraft.

SECTION 7

Customers and Contracts

Aurelia's largest single customer by contract value is the U.S. Space Force, which has awarded the company two national security launch contracts under a program intended to expand the pool of certified medium-lift providers beyond the two long-standing incumbents. The first of these missions is expected to fly from Cape Canaveral in 2027.

On the commercial side, Aurelia holds a multi-launch agreement with Meridian Logistics Orbital, a satellite communications subsidiary of Meridian Logistics, the Columbus, Ohio-based distribution company, to deploy a regional broadband constellation. Aurelia also supplies Corvus buses to Solstice Constellations, a Singapore-based satellite operator building an Earth-observation fleet.

In 2025, Aurelia signed its first orbital-servicing contract, agreeing to extend the operational life of two geostationary satellites owned by Cascade Communications, a satellite television operator based in Denver, Colorado, using the Tether spacecraft once it completes qualification testing.

SECTION 8

Funding History and Investors

Aurelia has raised approximately 1.3 billion dollars in outside capital across five priced rounds since its 2016 founding. Halbard Growth Partners led the company's Series B round in 2019 and has participated in every subsequent round, making it Aurelia's largest outside shareholder.

Other investors include Kepler Strategic Capital, a Chicago-based investment firm that led Aurelia's 2022 Series D round, and Solaris Sovereign Fund, a sovereign wealth vehicle based in Abu Dhabi that joined as a strategic investor in the March 2025 round alongside Halbard. Solaris Sovereign Fund also holds stakes in two other launch companies, which Aurelia has stated does not create a conflict under its current governance agreements.

Aurelia's Chief Financial Officer, Elise Marchetti, has said publicly that the company does not plan to pursue an initial public offering before 2028 at the earliest, citing the capital intensity of scaling Halcyon II production.

Funding Round Summary

Round	Year	Lead Investor	Notes
Series A	2017	Undisclosed angel group	Seed engineering team
Series B	2019	Halbard Growth Partners	First institutional round
Series C	2020	Halbard Growth Partners	Funded Halcyon I flight program
Series D	2022	Kepler Strategic Capital	Funded Driftline acquisition
Series E	2025	Halbard Growth Partners	Solaris Sovereign Fund joined as strategic investor

SECTION 8A

Financial Snapshot

Aurelia Aerospace does not publicly disclose full financial statements as a privately held company, but has shared selected figures with investors and, in limited form, with trade press. The company reported approximately 210 million dollars in revenue for fiscal year 2025, split roughly evenly between launch services and satellite bus sales, with orbital servicing revenue not yet material.

Chief Financial Officer Elise Marchetti has indicated that Aurelia expects to reach cash-flow breakeven on launch operations alone by 2027, assuming the targeted increase to twelve Halcyon II flights in 2026 is achieved, though she has cautioned that satellite bus and servicing lines are expected to continue operating at a loss through at least 2028 as those programs scale.

The company's 4.1 billion dollar valuation from its March 2025 Series E round represents an increase from an approximately 2.6 billion dollar valuation at the time of its 2022 Series D round led by Kepler Strategic Capital, a period during which Aurelia completed the Driftline Robotics acquisition and opened the Broomfield campus.

Selected Financial Figures

Metric	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025
Revenue (approx.)	\$95M	\$150M	\$210M
Halcyon II flights	3	4	6
Headcount (approx.)	980	1,220	1,450
Valuation (at round)	—	—	\$4.1B (Series E)

SECTION 9

Regulatory Matters and Legal Proceedings

Aurelia's launch operations are licensed by the Federal Aviation Administration's Office of Commercial Space Transportation. The FAA briefly grounded Halcyon II flights in late 2024 following an anomaly during a static-fire test at the Huntsville facility, though no vehicle was lost and flights resumed within six weeks after a review.

In 2023, Aurelia was named in a patent infringement suit filed by Thornbury Propulsion Labs, Marcus Oyelaran's former employer, alleging that elements of the Kestrel-7 engine design drew on proprietary combustion-chamber geometry developed during Oyelaran's tenure there. The suit was settled in early 2025 under confidential terms, and Thornbury has since continued to supply engine components to a separate, unrelated launch company.

Aurelia's environmental permit for expanded static-fire testing at Huntsville is administered by the Alabama Department of Environmental Management, which approved an expanded noise and emissions variance in 2024 following a public comment period.

SECTION 9A

Insurance and Risk Transfer

Launch and third-party liability insurance for Halcyon II missions is placed primarily through Meridian Orbital Insurance, an underwriter based in London, United Kingdom, on whose board independent Aurelia director Constance Ubah also serves. Aurelia has stated that Ubah recuses herself from any Aurelia board discussion of insurance terms given the dual board role.

The Cascade Communications servicing contract carries a separate policy, placed through a syndicate arranged by Meridian Orbital Insurance, covering potential damage to the client satellites during Tether's docking and refueling operations, reflecting the higher perceived risk profile of proximity operations relative to traditional launch insurance.

SECTION 10

Competitive Landscape

Aurelia competes most directly with Tidewater Launch Systems, a medium-lift launch company based in Denver, Colorado, which has flown a comparable vehicle since 2021 and holds a larger share of national security launch contracts to date. Tidewater and Aurelia have both bid on the same Space Force contract vehicle in each of the last three annual competitions.

In the satellite bus market, Aurelia's Corvus platform competes with offerings from Northgate Satellite Systems, based in El Segundo, California, where Aurelia's own Tobias Renner previously worked before joining Aurelia in 2020.

In orbital servicing, Aurelia Orbital Services is one of three companies currently qualifying servicing spacecraft for geostationary satellite life-extension work, alongside Continuum Space Operations, based in Herndon, Virginia, and a division of a much larger aerospace prime contractor that has not yet announced a commercial servicing product.

Selected Competitors

Company	Segment	Location
Tidewater Launch Systems	Medium-lift launch	Denver, Colorado
Northgate Satellite Systems	Satellite buses	El Segundo, California
Continuum Space Operations	Orbital servicing	Herndon, Virginia

SECTION 11

Conferences, Launches, and Public Events

Aurelia has used the annual Space Commerce Summit, held each spring in Washington, D.C., to make several of its major announcements, including the 2023 unveiling of Aurelia Orbital Services and, at the 2025 edition, the announcement of the Cascade Communications servicing contract. Nadia Kowalski has delivered the opening keynote at the Summit in each of the last two years.

The company's most closely watched public event to date was the maiden flight of the Halcyon II, which launched from Cape Canaveral in September 2022 carrying a demonstration payload for Vantage Materials. Marcus Oyelaran and Nadia Kowalski both attended the launch from the Huntsville mission control room.

In March 2024, Aurelia executives including CFO Elise Marchetti testified before a U.S. House subcommittee hearing on commercial space competition, held in Washington, D.C., where Marchetti argued for expanded government use of fixed-price launch contracts with newer entrants such as Aurelia.

Aurelia also exhibits annually at the International Astronautical Congress, whose 2025 edition was held in Sydney, Australia, where Priya Chandrasekaran presented a technical paper on the Tether servicing spacecraft's robotic docking system.

SECTION 11A

Risk Factors

Aurelia's business remains concentrated around a single active launch vehicle family. Any extended grounding of the Halcyon II, similar to the six-week pause following the 2024 static-fire anomaly, would directly affect both government and commercial launch revenue, given that the company does not currently operate a second active vehicle.

The company's reliance on Solenne Avionics for primary flight computers, partially mitigated by the Redline Systems secondary supply arrangement, remains a point of supply concentration that Aurelia has acknowledged internally following the 2022 avionics delivery delay.

Aurelia's orbital servicing business, still pre-revenue on the Tether spacecraft pending qualification testing, faces direct competition from Continuum Space Operations and the possibility that a larger, better-capitalized aerospace prime could enter the market with its own servicing product.

Ongoing litigation risk, illustrated by the 2023 Thornbury Propulsion Labs suit over Kestrel-7 engine design, remains a consideration given that several of Aurelia's senior propulsion staff, including Marcus Oyelaran, previously worked at competing or adjacent propulsion firms before joining the company.

SECTION 11B

Media Coverage and Public Perception

Aurelia has generally received favorable trade-press coverage tied to Halcyon II launch milestones, particularly the vehicle's 2022 maiden flight and the 2025 announcement of the Cascade Communications servicing contract, both of which were covered by major aerospace trade publications and several general-business outlets.

Coverage has been more mixed regarding the 2024 static-fire anomaly and subsequent FAA grounding, with some outlets characterizing the pause as a routine regulatory step and others framing it as evidence that Aurelia's launch cadence targets were overly aggressive relative to the company's testing infrastructure.

Nadia Kowalski has become a recurring commentator in aerospace industry media following her keynote appearances at the Space Commerce Summit, and is frequently quoted alongside executives from Tidewater Launch Systems in comparative coverage of the medium-lift launch segment.

APPENDIX

Key People Directory

The following table summarizes principal individuals referenced throughout this report, their primary affiliation, and role.

Name	Affiliation	Role
Nadia Kowalski	Aurelia Aerospace	Co-founder and CEO
Marcus Oyelaran	Aurelia Aerospace	Chief Technology Officer
Elise Marchetti	Aurelia Aerospace	Chief Financial Officer
Owen Bassett	Aurelia Aerospace (former)	Co-founder, departed 2019
Renata Cole	Aurelia Aerospace	VP, Flight Software; co-founder
Tobias Renner	Aurelia Satellite Systems	Vice President
Priya Chandrasekaran	Aurelia Orbital Services	General Manager; Driftline founder
Desmond Yates	Halbard Growth Partners	Partner; Aurelia board member
Constance Ubah	Aurelia Aerospace / Meridian Orbital Insurance	Independent director, both boards

APPENDIX

Facilities and Program Reference

Quick reference for facility names, program names, and their associated organization, used throughout this report.

Name	Type	Associated Organization	Location
Space Launch Complex 46	Launch pad	U.S. Space Force / Aurelia (user)	Cape Canaveral, Florida
Wallops Flight Facility	Launch site (option)	NASA / Aurelia (option holder)	Virginia
NASA Marshall Space Flight Center	Engine test stand	NASA / Aurelia (leased access)	Huntsville, Alabama
Space Commerce Summit	Industry conference	Independent organizer	Washington, D.C.
International Astronautical Congress	Industry conference	International Astronautical Federation	Sydney, Australia (2025 edition)

SECTION 12

Outlook

Aurelia's near-term roadmap centers on scaling Halcyon II launch cadence from six flights in 2025 to an internally targeted twelve flights in 2026, contingent on avionics supply from Solenne Avionics and continued turbopump deliveries from Castellan Precision Machining. The company has also signaled interest in a larger, reusable successor vehicle, tentatively referred to internally as Halcyon III, though no formal development program has been announced.

Whether Aurelia can convert its Space Force contracts and the Cascade Communications servicing agreement into a broader base of recurring government and commercial work, while fending off Tidewater Launch Systems on price and Northgate Satellite Systems on the bus side, is likely to determine whether the company pursues a public listing before the 2028 timeline Marchetti has previously cited.

This report is a fictional composite prepared for internal testing purposes. Any resemblance to real companies, individuals, or events is coincidental.